TIES THE CLUES TO THE SUSPECTS

Suspect statement forms

A one-page questionnaire each suspect fills in by hand. Four of its answers are the four traits the clues test, and we script those; everything else is theirs. The kids compare each clue to the forms, so no real person has to wear, own, or be anything.

Who fills one out

- **The Principal, the Gym Teacher, the Librarian:** send each their script, their answer card, and a blank form together. Forms come back with the videos by [Oct 23].
- **The Custodian:** nothing to do. The form is pre-stamped DECLINED TO COMMENT with the Bureau's "records" printed on it.
- **The Chief (teacher):** fills one out too, from her answer card. It matches every clue. It stays in the Detective's folder until deliberation.

Where they go on the day

- Four forms (not the Chief's) go on the suspect board beside the WANTED posters, from 1:30. Squads can walk over and read them any time.
- The typed summary of the same four forms is the suspect table in every case file, so squads can cross off at their station without leaving it.
- At 2:28, when a squad has crossed off all four, the Detective produces the fifth form. See below.

Form question	Clue that tests it	Answer that gets someone cleared
3. Shoe size	Clue 1 · Evidence Lab: footprint = 27 cm = size 10	The Librarian wrote 7
1. Where at 2:15?	Clue 2 · Ghostbuster Lab: "seen in hall at 2:15"	The Principal wrote "in a meeting"
4. What were you wearing?	Clue 3 · Cipher Room: "snagged my orange sweater"	The Custodian's records say blue
5. Squishies?	Clue 4 · Mummy Witness: the thief loves squishies	The Gym Teacher ticked "don't get them"

The deliberation script (2:28)

A squad says: "Everyone's crossed off." The Detective, loud enough for the room:

"Then your list is too short. Four clues, four facts about the thief. Size 10. In the building at 2:15. Orange sweater. Loves squishies. Who else was in this building yesterday?" *(Let them guess. Someone will say the Chief. The Chief: "I am NOT a suspect.")*

"Chief, you filled out a statement form like everyone else. For completeness. I have it right here." *(Pin it to the board next to the other four. Read it aloud, including the crossed-out "Don't be ridiculous.")* "Detectives, check it against your clues. Then write your warrants."

Optional tell for the sharp ones: the Chief wears something orange all party (a scarf from the bin is fine), and keeps one squishy on her desk, "confiscated."

ANSWER CARD · THE PRINCIPAL

Your Suspect Statement: what to write

Fill out the attached form in your own handwriting. The four answers marked ★ are scripted, because the detectives check them against printed evidence: copy those exactly. The rest are suggestions; write anything you like, and true is funnier. Hand the form back to whoever sent you this by [Oct 23], with your video.

★ **1. Where were you at 2:15?**	In a meeting. A meeting about the next meeting.
2. Who can confirm that?	Everyone at the meeting. All nine of them.
★ **3. Shoe size**	10
★ **4. What were you wearing?**	An orange sweater. School spirit.
★ **5. Squishies?**	Tick LOVE THEM. Explain: “I own ONE. It’s a cat. It’s for stress.”
6. Inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?	Tick DEFINE “INSIDE.”
7. Did you take the Jar?	No. Absolutely not. No.
8. Anything else?	I did not say squishies.

Why these answers: Your meeting alibi is what clears you (Clue 2, the timeline). Everything else keeps you looking guilty, which is the job.

SUSPECT STATEMENT

OFFICIAL

MRS. DRISCOLL'S DETECTIVE BUREAU · CASE #1031 · FORM S-1

Suspect Statement

Answer every question. Print clearly. This will be read by detectives aged nine and ten. They notice everything.

Name _____

Job at this school The Principal

1. Where were you yesterday at 2:15 PM?

_____

_____

2. Who can confirm that?

_____

3. Shoe size (we will check) _____

4. What were you wearing yesterday? Color counts. _____

5. Squishies. How do you feel about them?

☐ Love them ☐ Don't get them ☐ What is a squishy?

_____

6. Have you ever been inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Define "inside" _____

7. Did you take the Jar?

_____

8. Anything else the detectives should know?

_____

_____

_____

Signature _____

Date _____

OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Cleared by: ☐ Clue 1 footprint ☐ Clue 2 timeline ☐ Clue 3 orange sweater ☐ Clue 4 witness

ANSWER CARD · THE GYM TEACHER

Your Suspect Statement: what to write

Fill out the attached form in your own handwriting. The four answers marked ★ are scripted, because the detectives check them against printed evidence: copy those exactly. The rest are suggestions; write anything you like, and true is funnier. Hand the form back to whoever sent you this by [Oct 23], with your video.

★ **1. Where were you at 2:15?**	The gym. Where I always am.
2. Who can confirm that?	The dodgeballs.
★ **3. Shoe size**	10
★ **4. What were you wearing?**	Orange. It's a school color. Half the building wears orange.
★ **5. Squishies?**	Tick DON'T GET THEM. Explain: "You squeeze it. It goes back. That's it."
6. Inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?	Tick YES. Add: "To return a kickball. Once."
7. Did you take the Jar?	No. If I wanted to steal something, I'd steal a good jump rope.
8. Anything else?	I just don't understand the obsession these days.

Why these answers: Not getting squishies is what clears you (Clue 4, the witness). Don't soften it.

SUSPECT STATEMENT

OFFICIAL

MRS. DRISCOLL'S DETECTIVE BUREAU · CASE #1031 · FORM S-2

Suspect Statement

Answer every question. Print clearly. This will be read by detectives aged nine and ten. They notice everything.

Name _____

Job at this school The Gym Teacher

1. Where were you yesterday at 2:15 PM?

_____

_____

2. Who can confirm that?

_____

3. Shoe size (we will check) _____

4. What were you wearing yesterday? Color counts. _____

5. Squishies. How do you feel about them?

☐ Love them ☐ Don't get them ☐ What is a squishy?

_____

6. Have you ever been inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Define "inside" _____

7. Did you take the Jar?

_____

8. Anything else the detectives should know?

_____

_____

_____

Signature _____

Date _____

OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Cleared by: ☐ Clue 1 footprint ☐ Clue 2 timeline ☐ Clue 3 orange sweater ☐ Clue 4 witness

ANSWER CARD · THE LIBRARIAN

Your Suspect Statement: what to write

Fill out the attached form in your own handwriting. The four answers marked ★ are scripted, because the detectives check them against printed evidence: copy those exactly. The rest are suggestions; write anything you like, and true is funnier. Hand the form back to whoever sent you this by [Oct 23], with your video.

★ **1. Where were you at 2:15?**	Shelving. Alone. In the back. 2:00 to 2:30, every day.
2. Who can confirm that?	No witnesses. That sounded worse than I meant it to.
★ **3. Shoe size**	7
★ **4. What were you wearing?**	My orange cardigan.
★ **5. Squishies?**	Tick LOVE THEM. Explain: “One on every cart. Shelving is stressful.”
6. Inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?	Tick YES. Add: “Overdue books.”
7. Did you take the Jar?	No. If I had, they would be alphabetized by now.
8. Anything else?	Whoever took them... check their feet.

Why these answers: Your shoe size is what clears you (Clue 1, the footprint is a 10). Write 7 whatever your real size is.

SUSPECT STATEMENT

OFFICIAL

MRS. DRISCOLL'S DETECTIVE BUREAU · CASE #1031 · FORM S-3

Suspect Statement

Answer every question. Print clearly. This will be read by detectives aged nine and ten. They notice everything.

Name _____

Job at this school The Librarian

1. Where were you yesterday at 2:15 PM?

_____

_____

2. Who can confirm that?

_____

3. Shoe size (we will check) _____

4. What were you wearing yesterday? Color counts. _____

5. Squishies. How do you feel about them?

☐ Love them ☐ Don't get them ☐ What is a squishy?

_____

6. Have you ever been inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Define "inside" _____

7. Did you take the Jar?

_____

8. Anything else the detectives should know?

_____

_____

_____

Signature _____

Date _____

OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Cleared by: ☐ Clue 1 footprint ☐ Clue 2 timeline ☐ Clue 3 orange sweater ☐ Clue 4 witness

ANSWER CARD · THE CUSTODIAN

Your Suspect Statement: what to write

Nothing to fill in. The form is pre-stamped DECLINED TO COMMENT and the Bureau’s own records are printed on it. Sign the bottom if you like. On Oct 30, act shifty in the hallway.

SUSPECT STATEMENT

OFFICIAL

MRS. DRISCOLL'S DETECTIVE BUREAU · CASE #1031 · FORM S-4

Suspect Statement

Answer every question. Print clearly. This will be read by detectives aged nine and ten. They notice everything.

Name _____

Job at this school The Custodian

1. Where were you yesterday at 2:15 PM?

_____

_____

2. Who can confirm that?

_____

3. Shoe size (we will check) _____

4. What were you wearing yesterday? Color counts. _____

5. Squishies. How do you feel about them?

☐ Love them ☐ Don't get them ☐ What is a squishy?

_____

6. Have you ever been inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Once, inside _____

7. Did you take the Jar?

_____

8. Anything else the detectives should know?

_____

_____

_____

Signature _____ **Date** _____

Declined to comment

From Bureau records (suspect declined to comment)

Shoe size: **10** (boot closet). At 2:15: **in the building** (sign-in log). Wearing: **blue** uniform, every day. Squishies: **loves them** (seen squeezing one in the boiler room).

ANSWER CARD · THE CHIEF (MRS. DRISCOLL)

Your Suspect Statement: what to write

Fill out the attached form in your own handwriting. The four answers marked ★ are scripted, because the detectives check them against printed evidence: copy those exactly. The rest are suggestions; write anything you like, and true is funnier. Hand the form back to whoever sent you this by [Oct 23], with your video.

★ **1. Where were you at 2:15?**	In my classroom. Teaching. I live here, basically.
2. Who can confirm that?	Twenty children.
★ **3. Shoe size**	10
★ **4. What were you wearing?**	An orange sweater. It's festive.
★ **5. Squishies?**	Write "Don't be ridiculous," cross it out with ONE line so it can still be read, then tick LOVE THEM and write "Fine. Love them."
6. Inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?	Write: "It's MY room."
7. Did you take the Jar?	The Chief is never a suspect.
8. Anything else?	I would like it noted that I am not a suspect.

Why these answers: You match all four clues on purpose. This form stays in the Detective's folder until deliberation (2:28). When a squad has crossed off everyone, the Detective produces it, pins it to the board, and the room turns on you. Keep it off the wall until then.

SUSPECT STATEMENT

OFFICIAL

MRS. DRISCOLL'S DETECTIVE BUREAU · CASE #1031 · FORM S-5

Suspect Statement

Answer every question. Print clearly. This will be read by detectives aged nine and ten. They notice everything.

Name _____

Job at this school The Chief (Mrs. Driscoll)

1. Where were you yesterday at 2:15 PM?

_____

_____

2. Who can confirm that?

_____

3. Shoe size (we will check) _____

4. What were you wearing yesterday? Color counts. _____

5. Squishies. How do you feel about them?

☐ Love them ☐ Don't get them ☐ What is a squishy?

_____

6. Have you ever been inside Mrs. Driscoll's room?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Define "inside" _____

7. Did you take the Jar?

_____

8. Anything else the detectives should know?

_____

_____

_____

Signature _____

Date _____

OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Cleared by: ☐ Clue 1 footprint ☐ Clue 2 timeline ☐ Clue 3 orange sweater ☐ Clue 4 witness